# fn sample_bernoulli_rational

Michael Shoemate

February 17, 2026

This proof resides in **"contrib"** because it has not completed the vetting process.

**Warning 1** (Code is not constant-time)**.** `sample_bernoulli_rational` takes in an optional `trials` parameter to denote the number of trials to run. The current implementation does not guard against other types of timing side-channels that can break differential privacy, e.g., non-constant time code execution due to branching.

## PR History

- Pull Request #473

This document proves that the implementations of `sample_bernoulli_rational` in `mod.rs` at commit f5bb719 (outdated[1]) satisfies its proof definition.

At a high level, `sample_bernoulli` considers the binary expansion of `prob` into an infinite sequence `a_i`, like so: `prob` $= \sum_{i=0}^{\infty} \frac{a_i}{2^{i+1}}$. The algorithm samples $I \sim Geom(0.5)$ using an internal function `sample_geometric_buffer`, then returns $a_I$.

## 0.1 Hoare Triple

### Preconditions

- **User-specified types:**
  - Variable `prob` must be of type `T`
  - Variable `constant_time` must be of type `bool`
  - Type `T` has trait `Float`. `Float` implies there exists an associated type `T::Bits` (defined in `FloatBits`) that captures the underlying bit representation of `T`.
  - Type `T::Bits` has traits `PartialOrd` and `ExactIntCast<usize>`
  - Type `usize` has trait `ExactIntCast<T::Bits>`

### Pseudocode

```python
# returns a single bit with some probability of success
def sample_bernoulli_rational(prob: RBig, trials: Optional[int]) -> bool:
    numer, denom = prob.into_parts()
    return numer > UBig.sample_uniform_int_below(denom, trials)
```

[1] See new changes with `git diff f5bb719..5f50eff rust/src/traits/samplers/bernoulli/mod.rs`

**Postcondition**

**Definition 0.1.** For any setting of the input parameters `prob` of type `T` restricted to $[0, 1]$, and optionally `trials` of type `usize`, `sample_bernoulli_rational` either

- raises an exception if there is a lack of system entropy or if `trials` is set and it runs more than `trials` times, or
- returns `out` where `out` is $\top$ with probability `prob`, otherwise $\bot$.

If `trials` is set, the implementation's runtime is constant.

*Proof.* An integer sample is taken uniformly at random from $[0, denom)$, where `denom` is the denominator of `prob`. The implementation then returns $\top$ if the sample is less than the numerator of `prob`, and $\bot$ otherwise. Since only at most `numer` outcomes of $\top$ are possible, out of `denom` possible outcomes, the implementation returns $\top$ with probability `prob`.

The implementation runs in constant-time if `trials` is set. $\square$